

Python Introduction

Python is a high-level, interpreted, general-purpose programming language used to develop applications, websites, software, automation tools, data analysis, and artificial intelligence systems. Python has several features and strong community support, due to which it has a vast collection of built-in modules and libraries for a variety of applications.

Python is a high-level programming language known for its simple and readable syntax. Its high-level built in data structures, combined with dynamic typing and dynamic binding, make it very attractive for Rapid Application Development.

History of Python

In 1989, Guido van Rossum a Dutch programmer was working at a computer science lab in the Netherlands. At that time, he was working at **Centrum Wiskunde & Informatica (CWI)**, a research institute in the Netherlands. He decided to write a language that would improve on the faults of the most popular ones of his time.

In **December 1989**, Guido van Rossum began developing Python as a hobby project during the Christmas holidays. His goal was to create a programming language based **on ABC** that was easy to understand that was simple, readable, and easy to use, while still being powerful enough for real-world applications. The initial public release, **Python 0.9.0, was published in February 1991.** and the latest stable major version of Python is Python 3.14, released in October 2025.

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2001	Python Software Foundation established
The Python Software Foundation (PSF) is a non-profit organization established in 2001 to promote, protect, and advance the Python programming language. It was created specifically to manage Python-related intellectual property and support the Python community.	

Story behind Name

The language name does not originate from the snake; rather, it was inspired by the British comedy television series **Monty Python's Flying Circus**, of which Van Rossum was a big fan.

Guido van Rossum chose the name “**Python.**” It is often thought that the word ‘python’ refers to the **snake**. However, it refers to the British comedy television series, ‘**Monty Python's Flying Circus.**’